

Post-incident review PIR-2025-054

Payments API: delayed processing

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 27 November 2025, Payments API experienced delayed processing in production (US West) for about 40 minutes. The first signal was a spike in support tickets from merchants. Investigation found that the database ran out of connections under end-of-month batch load.

Impact

Users of Payments API saw delayed processing for about 40 minutes. The service owner, Payments Platform, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:09 First signal received.
- 09:35 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:54 Likely cause identified.
- 10:09 Mitigation applied.
- 10:50 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that the database ran out of connections under end-of-month batch load.

Certificates were checked as part of triage and were valid.

It took time to work out which team owned the affected component.

The change was made outside the approved maintenance window.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Write and rehearse a runbook for this failure mode.
- Move certificate renewal into the automated rotation pipeline.
- Exercise the rollback path in staging as part of every release.